



**AMBIKA
VISHWANATH**

CO-FOUNDER
AND DIRECTOR OF
KUBERNEIN INITIATIVE
AND CURRENTLY A
DFAT MAITRI PRINCIPAL
RESEARCH FELLOW AT LA
TROBE ASIA, AUSTRALIA

80 |

**THERE IS AN
OPPORTUNITY
FOR AFFECTED
COUNTRIES TO
BRING THEIR
COLLECTIVE
UNDERSTANDING
FOR MORE
EFFECTIVE
CLIMATE ACTION**

THE NEW GREEN ORDER

Partnerships between countries should consider relooking at climate trends to explore new pathways for long-term action

EVERY YEAR, FOR the last several years, has been deemed as the hottest year on record. 2025 has already surpassed previous numbers with January seeing temperatures of 1.75°C above pre-industrial levels. The trend is likely to continue. Rising heat is not the only manifestation of climate change, there have been more than usual forest fires, heavier monsoons and snowstorms, and more frequent cyclones. The rapid growth and scale of climate impacts, expected to increase exponentially according to IPCC reports, tells us plainly that no one is immune—not even the richer countries. Climate events in January 2025 alone have affected every single part of the planet, from massive storms in the UK to heavy rain and floods in Western Australia to record heat in Asia, South America and the Arctic.

The climate conversation now needs some serious reflecting and contemplation. COP29 in Baku was a failure, with lower-than-expected financial pledges from developed economies and lack of strengthening of previous commitments to move away from fossil fuels. There seems to be a sense of lethargy on part of the global community to adequately address these issues. In some ways, the collapse of global climate ambition offers the ability to re-think our

priorities and goals and strategise as a global community in a more inclusive manner.

For too long, climate conversations have largely been centred around long term mitigation strategies, often with little knowledge and understanding of myriad contextual realities—such as the focus on reduction of GHG emissions to stem the tide of the rising temperature through more renewables. Further, while the demand from developing countries in terms of financing, technology transfer, and addressing their historical injustices by the global majority continues to be necessary, we must also recognise that in the longer run new forms of climate cooperation and collective resilience based on context specific co-learning and co-action is needed. Industrial and post industrialised countries might be responsible for a majority of past emissions, but we cannot ignore the emissions of developing nations. Rightfully, many island nations and less developed economies are demanding action from both post industrialised richer economies and developing nations.

Within the subgroups, fast growing middle economies like India, Germany, Brazil could push for climate action that is equitable, balanced and homegrown. We need to move away from the donor organised